

Position Statement and high-level plan: Re-Opening Under Home Front Command Regulations

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Our guiding principles

1. Maximising face-to-face contact

We are committed to providing the maximum possible **in-person** contact between children, families and staff, within the boundaries of Home Front Command, Ministry of Education and Ministry of Health regulations.

2. Using every legal option – but never crossing the line

We will actively seek and use every lawful route to operate – essential-workers frameworks, non-formal educational activities and holiday-camp models – and may go to the **legal limit**, but we will not exceed limits on group size, shelter capacity or permitted activity type.

3. Shelter-first safety model and transparent capacity

All operations are designed around each site's **standard protected space** capacity, not its normal licence, so that everyone present can reach and fit into the protected space within the required warning time; this capacity and its implications are documented and communicated for each centre.

4. Guaranteed essential-workers provision in every nursery

Every nursery with a compliant protected space will operate an **essential gan** under the national procedure for children of essential workers in emergencies, and where local numbers are very low we will offer places at a nearby Newton Kids essential-gan, ensuring that every eligible family has access to face-to-face care.

5. Rapid progression back to normal daycare

Our clear aim is to return to **normalised daycare arrangements** – including full-day operation, age-group classes and, where needed, capsule structures – on a centre-by-centre basis as soon as restrictions allow. We will continuously monitor HFC and MoE updates, pre-prepare timetables and staffing plans, and commit to reopening in regular daycare mode **no later than the day after any official easing** that permits such operation, so there is no delay for children and families

Overview of proposed activities for the upcoming week

Newton Kids is implementing a layered re-opening model that maximises safe, in-person contact while fully complying with Home Front Command and Ministry of Education regulations. Across all centres with compliant protected spaces, we will:

1. Operate an **essential gan** framework for children of essential workers;
2. Run daily **stay-and-play family sessions** where parents attend with their children;
3. Provide **two-hour holiday-camp style activity blocks** (drop-off) for different age groups, everyday, all strictly limited by each site's safe-space capacity and delivered as non-formal educational activities rather than regular daycare.

Protected-space capacities by centre

Based on our current mapping of protected spaces, the maximum number of people (children + staff + accompanying parents) allowed on site at any one time will be:

Centre (branch)	Total enrolled children	Safe-space description	Max people allowed on site (children+adults)
Hadar Yosef	74	Two protected rooms, total 24 m ²	96
Ganei Tikva	90	Shelter 9 m ² + mamad 12 m ²	42
Kfar Shmaryahu	45	Mamad 37 m ²	75
Herzliya	67	Mamad 40 m ²	80
Neve Avivim	109	Shelter 45 m ²	90
Rainbow (Tel Aviv)	200	Shelter 90 m ²	180
Teena (Modiin)	83	Mamad 45 m ²	90
Haneviim (Modiin)	35	Large mamad 24 m ² + small mamad 12 m ²	72
Ra'anana	78	Shelter 35 m ²	70
Old North (Tel Aviv)	76	Two security rooms which are not compliant	Not permitted for on-site activity

Note: the “Max people allowed” column is derived from the HFC rule of approximately 0.5 m² per person inside a standard protected space; centres with multiple rooms combine capacities where both rooms are compliant.

Old North currently has no compliant protected space; therefore it will not host face-to-face activity until HFC policy changes or we relocate that group to a different protected venue.

Essential gan

Headline commitment and legal basis

- Newton Kids will open at least one **essential gan** in every centre that has a compliant protected space, using the national procedure for children of essential workers during emergencies and the exceptions in Annex '1 of the HFC policy (“Day-care centres for essential-workers’ children” and “Mafal frameworks”).
- Each essential-gan group will follow national rules on:
 - Eligibility (parent employed by a facility defined as “essential” by law/MoE/MoH).
 - Group size (0–3: up to 8 children per group; 3–12: up to 10 participants including staff).
 - Operation within or immediately adjacent to a standard protected space, within shelter capacity.
- Where fewer than 10 children at a centre meet the essential-worker criteria, we will offer families the option to attend an essential-gan group at another Newton Kids site (for example, combining two small cohorts into one group in a larger centre). This is consistent with the MoE guidance that essential-worker frameworks may be hosted in any compliant educational or community facility, not only the child’s regular gan.

A separate, detailed document will set out the essential-gan eligibility criteria, referral and verification process, group structure and daily timetable.

Stay-and-play sessions (parents stay with children)

Model

- Each centre (except Old North) will run **two 90-minute stay-and-play sessions per day**, one in the morning and one in the afternoon.
- Parents attend **with** their child; they remain on site and are responsible for the child in partnership with the staff team.

Legal rationale

- HFC and MoE define **non-formal educational activity** broadly to include meetings, clubs and group activities for children and families, with up to **30 children near or inside a standard protected space with at least two adults**, subject to shelter capacity.
- In this model:
 - The session is clearly **non-formal** (not regular daycare, no meals, short duration).
 - Parents are present, which reduces the degree of “childcare” being provided and frames the activity as a guided family session.
 - All participants remain in, or directly adjacent to, the protected space, so everyone can enter it within the prescribed warning time.

Parameters and restrictions

1. Group size

- Maximum: **30 children per session, plus** their accompanying parents and at least **2 Newton Kids staff**, provided the total does not exceed the site’s safe-space capacity listed above.
- Practical example: in Ra’anana (capacity 70), a stay-and-play group might include 20 children, 20 parents and 3 staff (43 people total).

2. Location

- Activities are held **inside the shelter itself** wherever feasible.
- In areas where HFC allows “activity near the protected space”, all play areas used must be immediately adjacent with a clear, unobstructed route to the shelter, and staff must be able to move everyone into the shelter within the local “protection time”.

3. Duration

- 90-minute sessions are acceptable; current guidance does not impose a specific time limit on non-formal activities, only on short “airing” breaks outside the shelter.

4. Food and drinks

- No organised meal service.
- Parents may bring a **personal snack and water** for their child; these are eaten in the activity room (ideally the shelter) to avoid additional transitions and crowding.

5. Booking and flow

- All sessions must be **pre-booked**; walk-ins are not allowed.
- Centres must ensure that, across all activities running simultaneously, the total number of people on site never exceeds the safe-space capacity.

Two-hour “holiday camp” activity sessions (drop-off)

Model

- Each centre will run **two-hour drop-off sessions by age group**, branded as holiday-camp style activities:
 - “Baby tummy-time and floor exploration” (0–1).
 - “Toddler art and craft”, “Playdough and baking”, “Music and movement”, etc.
- Parents drop off and collect children **within the two-hour window**; children remain the responsibility of the staff team during the session.

Legal rationale

- These sessions are organised as **non-formal educational activities / camps**, not as regular daycare, in line with HFC and MoE guidance that allows such activities for groups of children, including in programmes like “Holiday School / Nitzanim”, in approved localities.
- Non-formal activities are permitted with up to **30 children per group**, provided:
 - They operate within or immediately adjacent to a standard protected space.
 - Group size and total centre occupancy remain within shelter capacity.
 - No full meal service is provided and the activity day is limited in length (here, two hours per session).

Parameters and restrictions

1. Group size

- Up to **30 children per session** with a minimum of **2 staff per group**, assuming the centre’s safe-space capacity can accommodate the children and staff together.
- Children are organised in **fixed groups** per session; staff and children do not move between groups during the two-hour period.

2. Location and safety

- As with stay-and-play, sessions take place in the shelter or in a room directly adjacent to it with a guaranteed route and within the local protection time.
- Centres conduct a **short safety drill** at the start of each session so that children and staff know how to respond to an alert.

3. Duration and daily scheduling

- Each session is **two hours long** (e.g. 09:00–11:00, 11:30–13:30, 15:00–17:00).
- Centres may run multiple sessions per day, as long as:
 - Each child attends **only one session per day**.
 - Between sessions there is enough time to clear the space, clean, and manage transitions without overcrowding.

4. Food and drinks

- As with stay-and-play, there will be **no hot meal service**.
- Children may bring a personal snack and water, to be consumed under staff supervision in the activity room.

5. Registration and communication

- Sessions are advertised and recorded as **“holiday activity / camp sessions”** in line with MoE guidance on non-formal programmes and, where relevant, municipal camp-licensing requirements.
- Parents are informed in writing that:
 - This is not a full return to regular daycare.
 - Activities comply with emergency regulations and may be cancelled or moved online if HFC guidance tightens.

Ra’anana and Modi’in

For Ra’anana and Modi’in we recognise the possibility of an **immediate, partial return to on-site activity as early as Tuesday**, subject to final confirmation from the municipalities and the regional HFC guidance maps. Both cities are among the authorities that may be classified as “yellow” under the differentiated model, which allows local councils to reopen parts of the education system – especially kindergartens, special education and holiday-camp frameworks such as “School on Vacations / Nitzanim” – where there is compliant shelter and sufficient staffing. Newton Kids will therefore prioritise these centres for the first wave of implementation of our model: opening essential-gan groups for eligible families; launching stay-and-play sessions and two-hour holiday-camp style activity blocks for all other families; and standing ready, on a centre-by-centre basis, to transition from this

emergency structure back towards normal daycare operation **from the day after any formal announcement** that permits wider opening in Ra'anana and Modi'in.

In conclusion

To conclude, Newton Kids operates as a **private early-years provider**, not as a municipal or Ministry-run "School on Vacations / Nitzanim" operator. Recent announcements that official Pesach camps will not open in specific municipalities, including Ra'anana and Herzliya, apply to those state holiday-camp programmes and do not in themselves prohibit small-scale, privately operated, shelter-based activities that comply with Home Front Command and Ministry of Education emergency regulations.



Our planned essential-gan frameworks and non-formal stay-and-play and holiday-style activity sessions are therefore designed to remain fully within the legal space available to private providers, while offering families meaningful, face-to-face support even where municipal holiday camps are not running.